

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1987-12-25

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

dear bahá'í friends,

we enclose a copy of a new compilation entitled *The Covenant*, which was prepared by the research department at our instruction.⁴⁵⁻¹

The covenant of bahá'u'lláh, the 100th anniversary of the inception of which will be commemorated in 1992, must be the subject of sustained and concentrated study. Instituted by the revealer of God's word in this day to direct and canalize the forces released by his revelation, the covenant in essence guarantees the continuation of divine guidance after the ascension of the manifestation through the presence in the world of an institution to which all the friends must turn.

So important for the development of the faith at this time is the understanding of the covenant in all its aspects that it has been designated as a major theme of the Six Year Plan. It is our earnest hope that the new compilation, consisting of extracts which convey essential elements of the covenant, will serve not only to deepen the understanding and love of the believers for the covenant, but also to increase their level of conviction, and

their loyalty to the cause and its institutions. To this end you will undoubtedly wish to arrange for the compilation to be made available to the friends

⁴⁵⁻¹. The compilation is too lengthy to include here; see CC 1:111–29.44.8

45.1

45.2

45.3

1986–1992 • The Six Year Plan

79and, if translation is required, to have it translated in full into the main language or languages used in the areas under your jurisdiction. Should it be necessary to translate the text into vernacular languages of limited usage, you are free of course to prepare an abridged form by selecting extracts from the compilation.

with loving b ahá'í greetings,

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Indigenous Rights and Self-Determination

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]